

Team 1

T6

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“We pledge, on our honor, that we have neither received nor given any unauthorized assistance on this assignment.”

The main connection with the team was with Sam Macrino, a Regional Sales Director at Johnson & Johnson, who oversees an oncology focused sales team, including four direct managers, approximately ten cross-functional partners, and around 100 representatives (with 30 in his Southeast region). Sam Macrino is Gianna Macrino's father, so access to Johnson & Johnson was through that personal connection and he provided contact information to other members of his team as well. From Mr. Macrino's perspective, there are several contributing factors driving the uneven performance across teams. Some examples include inconsistent messaging and lack of alignment in overall output. The most significant issue highlighted is a lack of clear, consistent direction, with representatives and managers receiving input from multiple sources, leading to confusion about priorities. This has been due to an overabundance of tools, resources, and messaging formats (ex: extensive iPad materials, print, and email content), which creates an overload of information and inconsistent messaging to healthcare providers and patients. Additionally, performance is measured across too many metrics. Things such as doctor visits, goal attainment, account frequency, and responsiveness to "triggers" make it unclear which outputs matter most. Mr. Macrino also noted that there was variability in cross-functional manager alignment. There is an inconsistent adoption of messaging and gaps in clinical knowledge among representatives. All of which can contribute to uneven performance within the department. While the organization is well equipped with resources, these inefficiencies and lack of focus ultimately pull employees away from the core objective of serving patients and healthcare providers effectively.

Johnson and Johnson belongs to the pharmaceutical industry. The pharmaceutical industry focuses on discovering, developing, and producing drugs to prevent and treat diseases (Britannica). This industry plays a huge role in improving global health by creating medications

that help people live longer and healthier lives. It is a very large industry, with a global market size estimated at around \$1.5 trillion (Statista). Oncology represents one of the fastest growing segments because cancer cases are continuously increasing and there is a very high demand for new and more effective therapies (IQVIA). There are thousands of companies in the pharmaceutical industry, with approximately 2,600 firms operating globally, many of which compete directly with one another (IBISWorld). Some of the largest competitors include Pfizer, Johnson and Johnson, Roche, Merck, and AbbVie. These companies are constantly trying to develop better drugs and bring them to market faster than each other. The buyers of the pharmaceutical industry include hospitals, oncologists, and healthcare systems. The sales representatives that work for these top companies, try to sell their products to the hospitals. The main suppliers of the oncology industry are the bio tech companies, raw material providers, and clinical research organizations. These companies are the ones that help develop, test, and produce the products to provide them to the pharmaceutical industry, which then the pharmaceutical industry sells those products to the buyers in hospitals.

The pharmaceutical industry has several major business trends. One of the most important is the shift toward personalized medicine, where treatments are designed for individual patients rather than using a one-size-fits-all approach (Deloitte). This requires much more detailed and specialized communication across teams because there is much more information that the sales reps need to know (Deloitte). Another trend is the increased need for cross-functional collaboration between departments such as sales, marketing, and medical affairs. Since each group has different roles, priorities, and expertise, it becomes more difficult to ensure that all teams are aligned and communicating effectively, which contributes to inconsistent messaging and misalignment across teams, which is an issue that directly relates to the output

problems identified in this organization (McKinsey & Company). On top of that, companies are using more digital communication tools which has also changed how information is shared. This makes communication much more complicated because employees have to manage information across multiple platforms and figure out what is most important (Deloitte).

The pharmaceutical best practices really focus on safety, quality, and following strict regulations. Companies follow the Current Good Manufacturing Principles, which are rules to ensure that drugs are consistently produced and controlled according to quality standards set by the FDA(FDA). The companies also use quality management systems, standard operating procedures (SOPs), and required training programs to make sure employees do everything correctly and to meet their standards. The SOPs are step by step instructions for employees to do things the same way. The companies also perform internal audits to make sure that the company regularly checks if employees are following the rules. These practices are essential because even small mistakes can affect the patient's safety.

The pharmaceutical industry is already considered a highly mature industry meaning it has been developed over many years with stable structures, regulations, and major global competitors (Deloitte). The largest companies operate with advanced systems, standardized processes, and strict regulatory oversight. The industry focuses less on growth and more on innovation, efficiency, and maintaining a competitive advantage. Although the pharmaceutical industry is considered already mature, that doesn't mean it's done growing. This industry is continuing to grow and evolve as new treatments and technologies are constantly maturing. The main goal of the pharmaceutical industry is to prevent disease and provide treatments so minimizing that would allow the industry to become more mature (IQVIA).

The team collected data by conducting a series of interviews and surveys. They had two interviews with Mr. Macrino and an additional recent interview with Beth Winkley. Mr. Macrino represented the manager's perspective, whereas Beth represented the employee's perspective. After conducting the interviews, a survey was carried out of the South East Sales Division, which comprises 30 individuals: 4 managers and 26 employees. The team wished to receive all participation from all 30 individuals, but they only got 8 responses through our survey. This survey collected data until April 20, 2026. After data collection, Team 1 conducted a cross-analysis of the interview data with the collected data to identify consistencies and inconsistencies.

The primary output problem identified is an overly complex system driven by unclear direction, excessive information, and cross-functional misalignment. A clear common theme across the interview/survey data is the need for greater simplicity, clarity, and alignment across the organization. There are too many competing priorities, which makes it difficult for employees to determine what truly matters most. Performance is measured in multiple ways, creating confusion around which metrics should be prioritized. This leads to fragmented efforts and inconsistent execution across teams. Another recurring issue is misalignment across cross-functional groups, where individuals receive differing directions from multiple sources. This lack of consistency makes it harder for representatives to stay focused and execute effectively. Information overload is also a major concern, as employees are given an overwhelming amount of tools, content, and messaging as Mr. Macrino called it “an embarrassment of riches.” While these resources are valuable, the volume makes it difficult to apply them consistently. As a result, messaging to healthcare providers and patients can vary significantly. This inconsistency contributes to uneven performance across regions and teams.

There is a strong need to streamline priorities and reduce unnecessary complexity. Aligning around a clear and unified set of goals would help the team to improve focus, consistency, and overall output.

A concept that was learned in Management skills that was helpful with Team 1's analysis of the output problem at Johnson & Johnson's Southeast oncology sales team is the Goal Setting Theory. Goal Setting Theory explains that employee performance improves when goals are clear, specific, and properly prioritized, while also being supported by feedback and alignment. When these elements are missing or when goals conflict, employees struggle to focus their effort, which reduces overall performance. Goals like this lead to increase of focus, increase effort, and improvement on persistence. In contrast, when goals that are given to employees are too broad, not clear, or opposing, the performance tends to decline because they struggle to understand the goal and priorities. The theory also emphasizes the importance of feedback, goal commitment, and task complexity. Feedback allows employees to monitor their progress and adjust their performance, while goal commitment ensures that employees are motivated to achieve the goals. Additionally, when tasks are complex, clear guidance and support become even more important, as employees may otherwise struggle to effectively apply the goals in practice. In the case of Johnson & Johnson, these elements appear to be lacking. Employees are not receiving clear feedback on which performance metrics matter most, which reduces their ability to adjust and improve. Additionally, the complexity of managing multiple competing goals and performance measures makes it difficult for employees to stay committed to a single objective, further contributing to inconsistent performance. This theory emphasizes that specific goals must be clearly displayed and prioritized so the employees know what is most important. These

objectives line up with what has been discussed in class as “SMART” goals; specific, measurable, attainable, realistic, and time sensitive.

Based on the interview the team had with Mr. Macrino, there is compelling evidence that their goals are unclear and compete against each other, which has ultimately led to a negative impact on overall performance. He stated that goals in the sector are established quarterly, each goal is equated to a patient, and are aligned to the company’s overall forecast. He also stated that work performance is tracked and managed from various different sources. For example, some of the sources are doctors seen, goal attainment, frequency of visiting accounts, and how fast representatives are reacting to “triggers” (messages sent that they need to visit a patient). This reflects a lack of goal clarity and prioritization, which are key components of Goal Setting Theory, as employees are unable to determine which metrics should guide their performance. This also leads to vague or unclear directions, which is another obstacle being faced in this department. Shown in the survey data collected, employees reported a moderately strong understanding of goals (average = 4.63/5), which serves as a quantitative measure of perceived goal clarity, yet the responses that were open ended uncovered different perspectives of what the goals actually are (Rutgers Business School Johnson & Johnson Research Survey Q4). From the employee perspective, this shows that they believe that they understand the goals, but may interpret them differently when put into practice. For example, answers for this survey question ranged from “customer loyalty”, to “compensation”, and “making sure that they order prescriptions through J&J rather than other competition.” This indicates that although employees believe they understand the goals, there is inconsistency in how those goals are interpreted, which reflects a lack of alignment and clarity. This is further supported by insights from Beth Winkley, who noted that employees are expected to complete multiple administrative and

performance-related tasks, many of which feel redundant or constantly changing, making it difficult to prioritize which goals are most important.

Additionally, there has been inconsistent performance across all teams. Mr. Macrino said “Overall, the region is doing well but when zooming in to individual components some show no growth or decline and others are showing increases of 300%.” According to the Goal Setting Theory, goals that are unclear and competing against each other lead to effort distribution in different places, and inconsistencies in performance. Since the employees are evaluated on multiple competing factors, they are unable to direct their focus on what matters most. This results in uneven performance across all of the teams. This is compelling evidence that shows the lack of a singular, unified, clear cut goal has been a key factor of their output problem at J&J.

The second concept that is helpful with analyzing the output problem at J&J’s sales department for oncology is Informational Justice, which focuses on how clearly and effectively information is communicated to employees. Informational justice refers to whether or not the employees obtain structured, clear, concise, and understandable explanations of information from management. When information begins to be excessive, or disorganized, the employees may fail to fully grasp expectations which can ultimately lead to a negative impact on performance. This shows the importance of informational justice that was discussed in class in a practical setting, which puts a strong emphasis on providing employees with sufficient and clear explanations.

From this interview, the team was told by Mr. Macrino that there are multiple issues linked to the output problems. Some of these include inconsistent communication to healthcare professionals, inconsistent performance across all regions, and ineffectiveness of account management. The root cause of this is deeper than just those problems, as it is the challenge of

confusion caused by too much information. Mr. Macrino said that “they have a lot of things, but it can be too much.” For example, he explained that they have a 233-page interactive slide presentation that is accessible via iPad, print, and email, which he described as an “embarrassment of riches.” While this situation could be viewed as simple information overload, it can also be interpreted as an informational justice issue, as employees are not receiving information in a clear, structured, and usable way. Survey data supports this as employees rated the manageability of information lower (3.63/5), indicating that the volume of information may be overwhelming (Rutgers Business School Johnson & Johnson Research Survey Q7). While one could argue that the company is attempting to provide employees with as many resources as possible, which could be seen as “more than fair,” the lack of structure and prioritization ultimately reduces the usefulness of this information and contributes to confusion. In addition, in the survey that was conducted this question was posed to the participants; “Do you think that the communication of department/company goals has been consistent from management and the “home office?” and one of the responses to this question was “Some things I filter out to not overwhelm the team” (Rutgers Business School Johnson & Johnson Research Survey Q11). This respondent even noted that they have to “filter out” some information to avoid overwhelming the team which indicates that not all of the information is being communicated effectively. Similarly, Beth Winkley described that although there are hundreds of available resources, her team typically relies on only a small portion of them due to redundancy and lack of organization, indicating that information is not being communicated in a clear, structured, and usable way.

From an informational justice perspective, the issue is not merely a lack of resources, but rather how information is communicated. Even though employees are given excessive materials at their disposal, the information being provided lacks clarity, structure, and prioritization, which

are essential components of informational justice. As a result of this, employees encounter “information overload” which ultimately leads to not being able to determine what is most important. This minimizes clarity, hinders decision making, and leads to fluctuation in performance. Overall, the lack of clear cut, organized communication of information contributes directly to the output problem at J&J. It is distracting the representatives of the company from the main objective of “Right work, done well” or in their case, being able to effectively assist healthcare patients and providers.

When diagnosing management challenges for organizations and their subdivisions, it is extremely important to communicate those challenges and examine ways to address them. Two specific challenges when discussing the oncology department within Johnson and Johnson are in regard to goal setting theory and informational justice.

One challenge seems to be in relation to goal setting where goals are not clear and are often contradictory causing confusion amongst employees and managers. While employees report a relatively strong understanding of goals, this is subject to unique interpretations that are not often in agreement, resulting in uneven and inconsistent results. A way to address this challenge would be to create departmental goals using the Goal Setting Theory, by specifically utilizing SMART goals. By making them specific, employees should have a better understanding of their expectations, how they relate to the company’s objectives, in what way and time-frame they will be evaluated, and how achievable they are. So, instead of simply providing a goal of “[improving] patient outcomes”, a better goal would be to “increase patient’s follow-up completion rates by 15% within 6 months” (Rutgers Business School Johnson & Johnson Research Survey Q7). This creates a specific, actionable objective, that is easy to measure and is achievable. This would help reduce confusion and improve alignment by ensuring all employees

are working toward the same clearly defined objectives. Google is a clear example of a company, implementing clear objectives which has resulted in strong growth. In fact, Larry Page, a co-founder of Google, has publicly stated that OKR or Objective and Key Result goals “have helped lead [Google] to 10x growth, many times over” in John Doerr’s book *Measure What Matters* (Doerr 1). Similarly, Andrew Grove, designer of the OKR system, implemented such practices at his company Intel, whose stock grew exponentially, into a company worth 53.8 billion dollars today (Pines). Despite such measurable outcomes, there are downsides to implementing such a policy including employee resistance to change, time requirements, and an overfocus on numbers. Particularly, a change to the status quo would require time and money to train staff on new management strategies, and require training programs, consultants, software, as well as longer working hours. Additionally, an overfocus on numbers could cause lower service quality or an unhealthy work environment, costing worker production and overall outcome. Overall, implementing clear SMART goals could reduce confusion and improve performance through measurable objectives, but success would depend on balancing accountability with the costs of training, employee adjustment, and maintaining service quality.

Similarly, another challenge seems to be in regard to informational justice, where it seems that employees are not receiving clear information and explanation from management. It seems that there is a lack of clarity over information, largely due to large swathes of information that create confusion. Mr. Macrino, described this as an “embarrassment of riches”, and employees rated the clarity over information relatively low at approximately 3.63 out of 5 (Rutgers Business School Johnson & Johnson Research Survey Q7). A way to address this challenge would be to improve communication systems and simplify information sharing by focusing on shorter, more organized, and relevant updates rather than overwhelming staff with

high amounts of information at once. This would improve clarity and reduce information overload, allowing employees to focus on the most important tasks and communicate more effectively. For example, leaders could use weekly summaries to highlight the most important changes, and decisions, while also explaining why decisions are made so employees feel informed and respected. A similar approach was used by Satya Nadella at Microsoft, who hosted monthly employee town halls to connect with employees and use structured communication to improve clarity and trust. Rather than overwhelm employees with a plethora of information, Nadella used clear and concise messaging to connect with employees and build trust (Cirone). Similarly, at Ford Motor Company, Alan Mullaly implemented a weekly Business Plan Review to ensure all senior leaders openly shared progress, problems and priorities through a standardized format, with simple communication and clear guidelines (McKinsey & Company). Despite this success, a drawback of this approach could entail leaving important details out as a result of oversimplification. This can lead to misunderstanding among employees, creating further confusion. Additionally, implementing structured communication systems such as weekly updates or town halls can require significant time and effort, leading to slow decision making in the short term, backfiring on the goal of making communication clear and simple. Overall, while improving clarity and simplifying communication can reduce confusion and strengthen informational justice, it must be carefully balanced to avoid oversimplification and added administrative burden. Additionally, if communication becomes too simplified, employees may lack critical context needed for decision making, which could lead to mistakes or misaligned actions.

While these suggestions may help improve management practices, there is significant concern of its resistance from clients. In order to reduce this, the use of the Influence Principle of

Social Proof can show that well-known companies like Google, Intel, Microsoft, and Ford already use similar goal-setting and communication systems successfully. This helps because organizations are more likely to accept and adopt ideas that have already worked for others in the same industry, or for successful companies. Additionally, the Principle of Authority can be used by linking recommendations the team has gathered from this project to respected research and experts, such as Goal Setting Theory by Locke and Latham and leadership practices from Satya Nadella and Alan Mulally. This makes the suggestions offered more trustworthy because they are based on both research and real business leaders. Using both social proof and authority makes the recommendations feel proven and reliable rather than just opinions. As a result, the client is more likely to accept and apply the changes.

In conclusion, the performance challenges within Johnson & Johnson's Southeast oncology sales team stem primarily from a lack of clarity, alignment, and effective communication. While the organization and team is well equipped with extensive resources and operates within a highly advanced and competitive pharmaceutical industry, these strengths have contributed to complexity and confusion rather than improved performance.. The analysis conducted based on surveys and interviews with Johnson and Johnson employees revealed that unclear and competing goals, combined with information overload and inconsistent cross functional messaging, has made it difficult for employees to prioritize their efforts and execute consistently according to the standards in which they are expected to perform.

By applying concepts from the Management Skills course such as Goal Setting Theory and Informational Justice, it becomes evident that improving performance within the oncology department is less about increasing resources and more about refining how those resources are structured and communicated. As mentioned before, the establishment of clear, specific, and

unified SMART goals would help to align employees around shared priorities, while simplifying and organizing communication would reduce overload and improve decision-making company-wide. Although implementing these changes may present challenges in the beginning and have some setbacks initially, including resistance and increased short-term effort, the long-term benefits of improved focus, consistency, and effectiveness outweigh these concerns and would provide the department with greater benefits..

Ultimately, addressing these management challenges will allow the Johnson and Johnson Southeast Oncology team to better fulfill its core objective which is effectively serving healthcare providers and patients. In the pharmaceutical industry where precision, clarity, and trust are critical, creating a more focused and aligned work environment will not only enhance the team's performance, but also strengthen Johnson & Johnson's ability to compete and deliver value in the evolving pharmaceutical landscape and set themselves up for a more successful future in the industry.

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Appendix A Contact Log:

Date	Time	Name	Position	Location	Findings/ Notes
February 28	7:45 pm	Sam Macrino	Regional Sales director	Online	Asked him to be our person of connection Found that he was regional sales director for the southeast oncology department specifically lung He is in charge of 4 managers and 30 employees
March 8 2026	11:45 AM	Sam Macrino	Regional Sales Director	Online	Leads 4 managers, ~100 reps, 10 cross-functional partners (30 in Southeast Main focus: patients and healthcare providers (HCPs) Goals set quarterly, tied to patient numbers Overall performance is good, but inconsistent across teams Some areas show no growth, others up to 300 Too many performance metrics → confusion (visits, goals, triggers, etc.) Messaging to patients/accounts is inconsistent Reps need stronger clinical knowledge Work assigned by territory based on patient count Too

					much information (“embarrassment of riches”) 200+ resources (iPad, email, print) → overwhelming Multiple sources of direction → unclear priorities Cross-functional misalignment Unclear direction Too many priorities/metrics Information overload Takes focus away from patients Reduces efficiency and consistency Reduce number of metrics Simplify communication Focus on one clear goal Previous role had clearer metrics and goals Current role is more complex and harder to manage Main issue: lack of one clear, unified objective
April 16 2026	10:00 AM	Beth Winkley	District Manager	Online	Team is productive overall Too many tasks/metrics → hard to prioritize A lot of admin work (expense reports, templates) takes time Templates and processes change often → inefficient 200+ resources available but only a few actually used A lot of information is repetitive/unnecessary Communication across teams is inconsistent Lack of documentation → duplicate work Main issues: too much

					information, unclear priorities, inefficiency
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Appendix B: Survey Data:

1. What is your role in the Southeast Oncology Sales Division?



2. How effectively do coworkers in your department communicate with each other in-person or online?

8
Responses

4.5
Average Number

3. How effectively/promptly do coworkers in your department respond to offline communications (i.e. text messages, emails, etc)

8
Responses

4.75
Average Number

4. How well do you understand the primary objective or goal your team is expected to achieve?

8
Responses

4.63
Average Number

5. How well do you understand the goals communicated by leadership?

8
Responses

4.63
Average Number

6. How is the communication between your team and cross functional partners?

8
Responses

4.25
Average Number

7. Is the number of materials and information provided to you manageable?

8
Responses

3.63
Average Number

8. Do you feel as if the current level of resources you are given to complete any task/responsibilities are enough?

0

4

9. Do you feel personally driven and connected to the company's objectives?

8
Responses

4.5
Average Number

10. What would you define as the goal/motivation of your work?

8
Responses

Latest Responses

"To inspire a team to wake up everyday with the purpose of convinc...

"Loyalty to customers and patients. Compensation as well."

"Helping patients achieve a meaningful impact on their cancer. My ...

11. Do you think that the communication of department/company goals has been consistent from management and the "home office?"

8
Responses

Latest Responses

"Pretty much so - some things I filter out to not overwhelm the tea...

"Inconsistent "

"Overall, I think they do a good job of keeping us up to date and in...

12. Do you believe there are ways to improve the service your company provides to patients and HCPs?

7
Responses

Latest Responses

"Yes but compliance is always something that can get in the way "

"Yes. "